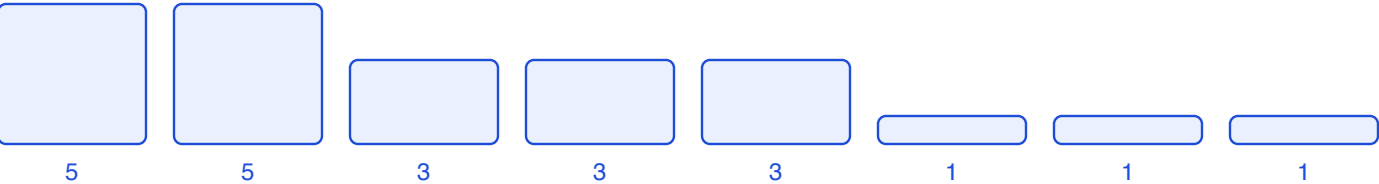


EVERY CHANGE IS PAID BY A DROP

the answer along one run



the potential: survivors ϕ (never rises; drops at every flip)



2 flips + 1 remaining ≤ 5 at the start

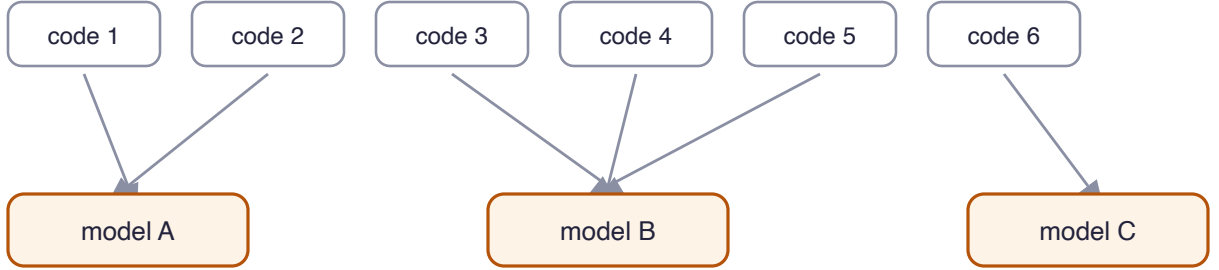
to bound revisions of ANY dial, exhibit one non-rising quantity that drops when the dial moves; the count plus what remains never exceeds what you started with. All revision laws are this line.

THE LEAST WITNESS SETTLES, EVEN OVER INFINITELY MANY



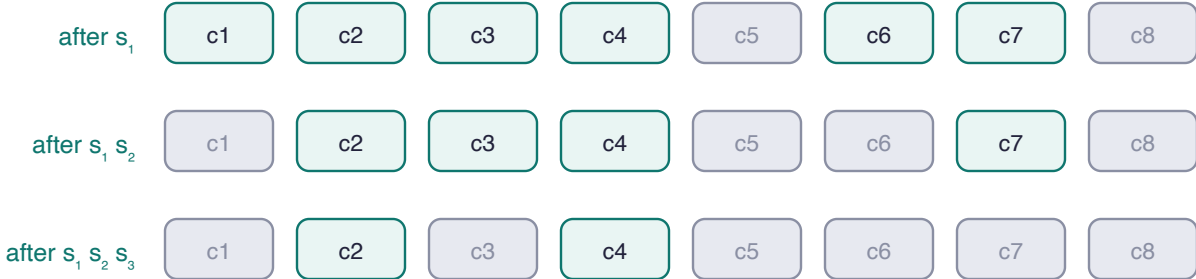
each candidate below the least fitting one dies at a finite time; past the last death the least fit is selected forever. No size bound needed: the ordering does the work of finiteness.

COUNT THROUGH THE IMAGE, NOT THE DOMAIN



six encodings, three behaviors: revisions are priced by the three, never the six. Making the map one-to-one turns the bound into an equality.
a count that factors through a map is priced by the image; duplicates never cost.

EVIDENCE CONCATENATES, SURVIVORS INTERSECT



append evidence = intersect survivor sets: order-free, only shrinking, and an empty set never refills.